



The Terminal Reads Foot Traffic as Feedback

Interviewing IT Service Desk Staff and Passers-By About Who Presses It, and When

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Background

A three-button terminal beside the IT Service Desk counter is read as a live service-quality signal, feeding a quarterly forecast of brewing problems. Little is known about who presses it, or whether a press follows an actual desk interaction at all.

Aims

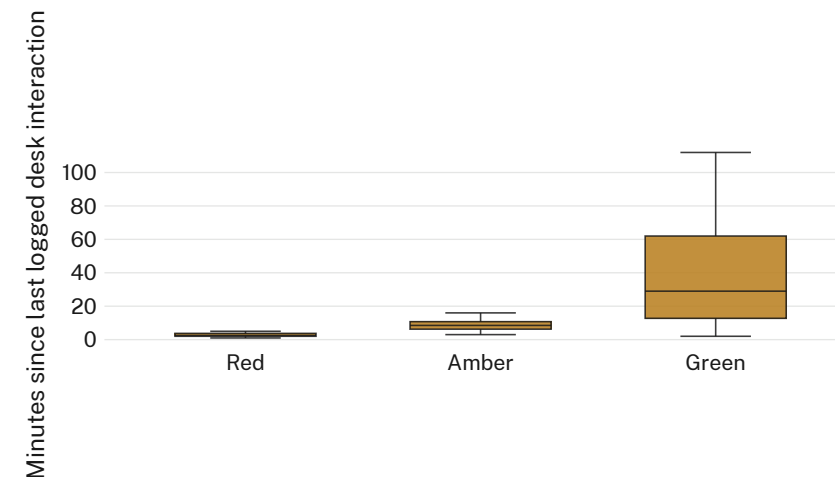
- Identify who presses the terminal, and in what circumstance
- Measure how closely each press follows a logged desk interaction, by button colour
- Test whether the tally supports its early-warning framing

Methods

- 214 presses logged over six weeks to 5 June 2026, matched to the desk's ticket-close log within a ± 10 -minute window
- 34 semi-structured interviews: desk staff, IT technicians, passers-by intercepted beside the terminal
- Match window pre-registered at ten minutes; not adjusted post hoc

Results

Red presses cluster within minutes of a ticket closing; green presses spread across the working day, with over a third recorded more than thirty minutes from the nearest logged interaction. Interviews trace the gap to passers-by who press out of habit, boredom, or to check that it still works.



Median lag between a logged desk interaction and the following press: 2 minutes (red), 8.5 minutes (amber), 29 minutes (green); $n = 214$, six weeks to 5 June 2026.

Discussion & conclusions

A third of the tally isn't reacting to any service event the desk can find. The early-warning read treats ambient foot traffic as signal. Next: pilot a cover screen hiding the terminal between confirmed interactions.

References

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3. Greenleaf, E. A. (1992). Measuring extreme response style. *Public Opin. Q.*, 56(3), 328–351. doi:10.1086/269326
4. Groves, R. M. (2006). Nonresponse rates and bias in household surveys. *Public Opin. Q.*, 70(5), 646–675. doi:10.1093/poq/nfl033
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De-identified interview data only; desk-log matching used ticket timestamps, not footage. Match window pre-registered; none adjusted post hoc.

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“Most red presses follow a ticket. Most green ones don't.”

38% of tallied presses trail no logged desk interaction within thirty minutes.